

STAGE TIMELINE

STAGE 0

Wks 0–8 ·
Validate

STAGE 1 · BUILD

Months 0–6

STAGE 2 · LAUNCH

Months 6–12

STAGE 3 · SCALE

Y2–Y3 · UK + US



Each stage has explicit go / no-go criteria. We commit only the next stage. ★ = future Series A funded scale.

STAGE 0 – VALIDATE & SET UP *Weeks 0–8 · Pre-build*

VALIDATION

- **Regulatory pathway** (4 wks, external counsel) – own AFSL vs partnership vs general-advice scenario tool. Decision unblocks compliance build.
- **Vendor spike** (2 wks, internal eng) – voice stack (Vapi vs Bland vs Twilio+Deepgram); confirm pricing & SLAs.
- **Partner appetite check** (6 wks, BD) – sound out Iress, Intelliflo, Envestnet + 2–3 super funds. Yes / no signal on Layer 3 thesis.
- **Recommendation engine API spec** + actuarial review (2 wks, Pavel + Tom) – signs off what Akane can / can't say about EPM.
- **Senior AI Product Lead hire** – start search now; offer ideally accepted by week 8.

Gate to Stage 1: regulatory model decided · vendor selected · partner appetite signal received · actuarial sign-off · product hire accepted (or strong shortlist). All five required to commit Stage 1 budget.

STAGE 1 – BUILD *Months 0–6*

LAYER 1 – parallel workstreams

- **L1.1 Conversation engine** – state-machine intake (per Intake Flow doc). 1 sr eng, 8 wks.
- **L1.2 Recommendation engine** – wraps existing calc engine. Eng + Tom review. 6 wks.
- **L1.3 Web UI** – chat + sliders / charts / cards. Frontend eng + UX designer. 8 wks parallel.
- **L1.4 Voice integration** – Vapi (or chosen). 1 eng + voice contractor. 6 wks after core.
- **L1.5 Compliance & audit** – disclosure, audit trail, adviser handoff. 1 eng + legal. 4 wks.
- **L1.6 Persistent memory** – sessions, resume, family-share. 2 wks.
- **L1.7 Observability** – analytics, drop-off, recommendation quality dashboard. 2 wks.
- **L1.8 Closed alpha** (50 users, friends & family). 4 wks.

LAYER 2 – smaller team, parallel

- **L2.1 MCP server** + core tools. 1 sr eng, 4 wks.
- **L2.2 OpenAPI spec**, schema, auth, rate limiting, docs. 1 wk parallel.

Gate to Stage 2: alpha NPS strong, conversion lift demonstrated, no compliance breaches, MCP server stable, schema published, Pavel / Tom sign-off on rec logic.

STAGE 2 – LAUNCH *Months 6–12*

LAYER 1

- L1.10 GA launch (AU) · L1.11 Voice channel · L1.12 Multilingual (CN, VN)
- L1.13 Continuous A/B testing of message variants & rec logic
- L1.14 Family-share feature · L1.15 Production-data iteration

LAYER 2

- L2.7 Anthropic MCP marketplace · L2.8 OpenAI plugin store · L2.9 Google A2A directory

LAYER 3 – kicks in

- L3.1 First partnership push – Iress / Intelliflo (most-likely first integrations)
- L3.2 Co-marketing with Anthropic on MCP launch
- L3.3 Schema authority – engage FSC working group · L3.4 Conferences (RIC, AI in FS)

Gate to Stage 3: Akane GA stable · ≥ 2 partner LOIs · material agent-attributed customer acquisition · MCP traffic emerging.

STAGE 3 – SCALE *Year 2 → Year 3 · UK + US*

LAYER 1 – multi-region rollout

- L1.20 UK launch (Q2/2027) – localised regulator (FCA Consumer Duty), currency (GBP), product spec.
- L1.21 US launch (Q4/2027) – localised regulator (SEC + state RIA), currency (USD), product spec.
- L1.22 Continuous learning loop matures – actuarial recalibration based on production data.
- L1.23 **Akane v2 rebuild** (months 18–24) – leveraging compounded data; Layer 1 depreciates and we reset.

LAYER 3 – ecosystem maturity

- L3.10 Partnership scale across regions – target multiple integrations across adviser tools, super / pension fund AI, consumer assistants.
- L3.11 Standards working group seats (FSC, AFA, AIST · UK PFS · US CFP Board) · L3.12 Thought leadership in agentic-FS space.

Continuous gate: agent-attributed customer acquisition tracking to plan · live partner integrations across regions · schema authority recognised in industry references. Stage 3 funded from future Series A.

Akane – Implementation Plan (cont.)

INTERNAL · BUILD PLAN

Resourcing · Critical path · Discipline

May 2026

RESOURCING

ROLE	SOURCE	WHEN	NOTES
Senior AI Product Lead	New hire	Stage 0 (accept by wk 8)	Owns L1 product direction; inherits UX + Flow docs.
Senior full-stack engineers (x2)	Existing or new	Stage 1+	Conversation engine, UI, voice.
AI / ML engineer	Tom Neilsen + 1 hire	Stage 1+	Rec logic, evals, feedback loop.
UX designer	Contractor / hire	Stage 1+ (initial 8 wks)	Mixed UI – sliders, charts, cards.
Voice integration specialist	Contractor	Stage 1 (L1.4)	Vapi / Twilio, voice flow.
Backend engineer (Layer 2)	Existing or contractor	Stage 1 (part-time)	MCP, OpenAPI, schema, marketplace.
Compliance & legal counsel	External (AU AFSL counsel)	Stage 0+	Regulatory pathway + audit + locales.
Pavel + Tom (actuarial)	Existing	Stage 0 + ongoing	Sign off rec logic; recalibrate.
Partnership / BD lead	Mike + Max → dedicated hire	Stage 0 → Stage 2+	Adviser tools, funds, marketplaces.
CMO / Marketing	Margaret Rochford (existing)	Stage 2+	Co-marketing, conferences, content.
Senior US distribution lead	New hire (in plan)	Stage 3 (Q4/2027)	Per existing capital raise plan.

CRITICAL PATH & DEPENDENCIES

HARD DEPENDENCIES (BLOCK DOWNSTREAM WORK)

- Regulatory pathway decision** blocks L1.5 (compliance infrastructure design) and the customer-facing language Akane uses.
- Recommendation engine spec sign-off** (Pavel / Tom) blocks L1.2 build – we don't write logic before the actuarial team approves it.
- Senior product hire** blocks L1 design leadership – current team can build, but product direction needs dedicated owner.
- Vendor selection** (voice stack) blocks L1.4 – different vendors need different integration patterns.
- L2 schema definition** must precede L3 partner integrations – partners integrate against the schema, not against working code.

WATCH-POINTS & SOFT DEPENDENCIES

- Partner appetite signal** – if Stage 0 sounds out comes back weak across all partners, scale Layer 3 ambition back, double down on Layer 1 differentiation alone.
- Anthropic MCP marketplace policies** may evolve – keep the OpenAPI surface as a parallel path so we're not exclusively dependent on one platform.
- The feedback loop** requires usage volume – first 6 months of GA in AU will be sparse data. Don't over-tune early.
- Akane v2 rebuild (month 18-24)** is intentional – Layer 1 is a depreciating asset. Plan for it; don't be surprised by it.

DISCIPLINE & DECISION POINTS

DISCIPLINE (EVERY STAGE)

- Optionality, not features.** Stage 1 choices preserve our ability to swap vendors, protocols, agents – without re-architecting L2/L3.
- Stage gates are non-negotiable.** Failed criteria = kill or de-scope, never "push through".
- Quarterly AI landscape review** – sr product lead + CTO + external advisor; calendared.
- Layer 1 depreciates; Layers 2 & 3 compound.** Invest accordingly.
- Every conversation captured** – outcomes feed back to the rec engine.
- Compliance is built in Day 1**, not bolted on at GA.

DECISION MOMENTS MANAGEMENT OWNS

- Week 8** – Stage 0 gate. Commit Stage 1 budget?
- Month 6** – Stage 1 gate. Move to Stage 2 (GA + first partnerships)?
- Month 12** – Stage 2 gate. Move to Stage 3 (UK + US scale)? Usually contingent on Series A close.
- Month 18** – Akane v2 rebuild scoping. What survives, what gets rebuilt?
- Quarterly throughout** – AI landscape review. Does our plan still fit reality?